

Hear → Repeat → Practice → Form a Habit

- * Listening and Speaking comes first.
- * Skills are very important.
- * Habit formation. Errors are discouraged.
- * Dialogue is used.
- * Grammar is taught through patterns.

Theoretical Foundation -

Structural linguistics → language is system of patterns + structures

Behaviourism → Stimulus → Response → Reinforcement

- * This two together make base for Audio-lingual Method.

5. Audio-Visual Method - Teaches language through a combination of audio (what learners hear) and visual (what learners see).

Features -

1. Audio + Visual Together
2. Meaning through situation
3. Oral language is important
4. Dialogue is important
5. Vocabulary is presented in context
6. Visual materials are important - pictures, slides, films, charts, objects, visual sequences

Sources and history - French language teaching in the mid 20th century.

- * It developed strongly at the Centre de recherche et d'étude pour la diffusion du Français (CREFE) and is associated with scholars such as Georges Gougenheim, Paul Rivet and Peter Gougenheim.
- * It developed in post world war II period when there was a growing need for practical language teaching and efficient oral communication.
- * The method drew on developments in structural linguistics, spoken language teaching, audio technology, visual materials and situational teaching.

Techniques - Presentation, Listening, Repetition, Question-answers, Pattern practice, Role-play, Recombination.

Theoretical Assumptions -

1. Language is primarily oral.
2. Language is learned in meaningful situations.
3. Visual Context helps understanding.
4. Language patterns are important.
5. Learning should involve the senses.
6. Communication is important.

Cognitive Theory - Language learning involves thinking, understanding, mental processing and the active participation of the learner.

- It argued human beings understand and creatively use language.

Main features -

1. Learning is a mental process.
2. Understanding is important.
3. Meaning is important.
4. Learners are active.
5. Errors can be meaningful.
6. Creativity is important.

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Teaching of English Features

The teaching of English - Before teaching, we need to understand what exactly makes up spoken English.

English pronunciation can be studied at two levels -

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- i) Segmental features of English - Segmental features are the individual speech sounds / separate sounds that make up spoken English.

- * Segmental features are the separate consonant and vowel sounds of a language.

For example - Cat → /k/ + /æ/ + /t/

Here, /k/, /æ/ and /t/ are individual sounds. So, Individual sounds = Segmental features.

Main features - Two major categories -

1. Vowels - Produced when air passes through the mouth without complete blockage.

Examples - /i:/ as in see, /ɪ/ as in sit,

/æ/ as in Cat

Vowels can be -

1. Short vowels - /ɪ/, /e/, /æ/, /ʌ/
2. Long vowels - /i:/, /a:/
3. Diphthong - Involves movement from one vowel sound toward another within the same syllable.

Examples - /eɪ/ → day, /aɪ/ → my

2. Consonants - Produced when the airflow is blocked or restricted somewhere in the speech organs.

Examples - /p/ → Pen, /b/ → bat

Voiced and Voiceless Consonants -

1. Voiced Sounds - The vocal cords vibrate. Examples - /b/, /d/, /g/
2. Voiceless Sounds - The vocal cords do not vibrate. Examples - /p/, /t/, /k/, /f/

ii) Suprasegmental features of English -

Pronunciation features that operate over individual sounds, especially across syllables, words and sentences.

Suprasegmental - Sound features ABOVE/ACROSS individual sounds, features that extend over sounds

Main features are -

1. Stress - Greater prominence or emphasis to a particular syllable or word.

Example - Table - first syllable is stressed

- a) Word Stress - Stress occurs within a word

Example - PREsent → noun, preSENT → verb

- b) Sentence Stress - Some words in sentence receive more prominence than others.

Example - I WANT the book.

- A The important words receive stronger stress. Generally content words like nouns, main verbs, adjectives or adverbs.

2. Rhythm - Pattern of stressed and unstressed syllables in spoken English.

Example - I WANT to go to SCHOOL.

The important stressed words stand out. Rhythm makes English speech sound more natural and fluent.

3. Intonation - Rise and fall of pitch in speech.

4. Musical movement of the voice while speaking.

Example - You are coming ↓ voice generally falls. Statement

Are you coming? ↑ voice may rise. Question

4. Juncture / Pausing - Juncture → how sounds or words are connected or separated in speech. Pauses also help listeners understand how speech is organized.

Example - Let's eat, Grandma and
Let's eat Grandma

The first sentence has a pause that changes the interpretation completely.

Teaching the mechanics of English - This are called mechanics because they deal with the basic skills and components learners need to use English effectively.

A. Pronunciation - Way words and sounds are produced and spoken.

It includes: Individual sounds + Stress + Rhythm + Intonation + Connected speech

4. Good pronunciation helps learners speak clearly, understand others, be understood by others and communicate effectively.

B. Vocabulary - Collection of words that a person knows or uses in a language.

4. Ways of teaching Vocabulary are Objects / Relia, pictures, Demonstration, Context, Synonyms and antonyms, word formation, word associations

C. Reading - Process of understanding and interpreting written language.

4. Reading is not simply saying words aloud.

- * A learner must understand - words + sentences + ideas + relationships + Overall meaning
- D. Writing - Process of Communicating ideas, information, feelings, or opinions through written language.
- * Good writing involves - Ideas + Organization + Grammar + Vocabulary + Sentence Structure + Spelling + Punctuation

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Audio-Visual and Supplementary Aids

Teaching Aids - Materials, tools or devices used by teachers to make teaching clearer, easier, more interesting and more effective.

Example - Pictures, Charts, maps, flashcards, recordings, videos, films, slides, objects, language laboratory equipments

Audio Aids - Teaching materials that learners mainly hear.

Example - Audio recordings, Radio, Recorded dialogues, Songs, Recorded speech,

- * They are especially useful for listening and pronunciation.

Visual Aids - Teaching materials that learners mainly see.

Example - Pictures, Charts, Maps, Flashcard, slides, posters, silent visual materials

- * They help learners understand concepts through seeing.

Audio-Visual Aids - Learning through hearing + Seeing

Example - Videos, films, educational television, multimedia presentations, recorded conversations with pictures, animated lessons

Use -

- Make learning interesting.
- Make difficult ideas easier.
- Improve understanding, memory, pronunciation and listening.
- Create realistic situations.
- Increase motivation.

Aids Supplementary to Textbooks -

Supplementary - Additional or extra

- * Supplementary aids are materials used in addition to the main textbook.
- * They do not necessarily replace the textbook. They support and enrich it.

Need - listening material, pictures, real-life situations, vocabulary practice, pronunciation

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Examples of Supplementary Aids - Workbooks, Newspapers,

Magazines, Storybooks, Pictures, Flashcards, Charts, Maps, audio recordings, Videos and films, Dictionaries, Real objects / Realia

Planning for Language Laboratory -

Language laboratory - Specially designed facility where learners use audio or digital technology to practise language skills, especially listening, pronunciation, speaking, oral communication.

- * A place where students practice language using special audio/digital equipments.

Why Plan? → Requires careful planning because the teacher must consider Purpose, Number of Students, Equipment, Room Arrangement, Materials, Teacher Training, Maintenance.

Language Laboratory Systems - Language laboratories have developed over time. The easiest way to understand this system is by considering how much control and interaction the system provides.

1. Simple / Conventional laboratory - Based
on audio technology. Students usually have headphones and microphones.
Main use - listening + Pronunciation + Repetition
2. Teacher - Controlled Systems - The teacher has a central control unit. Teacher can send materials to students, listen to students.
3. Computer - based / Multimedia laboratory - Use computers and digital systems.
4. Networked language laboratory - Students computers/headsets are connected through a network.
5. The teacher can often distribute materials, monitor students, communicate individually.

Specific Advantages provided by language laboratories -

Individual Practice, More listening Practice, Pronunciation practice, Speaking practice

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Unit - 5

Language Testing

Language Test - Planned assessment used to find out what a learner knows or can do in a language.

Principles of Test Construction - A good language test should be Valid, Reliable, practical, objective, appropriate.

Steps in Constructing a Language Test -

Decide the purpose → Identify the learners
→ Select Content → Select Techniques →
Prepare Questions/tasks → Decide Scoring
→ Administer the test → Interpret results

Use of language test - Measure achievement, Diagnose difficulties, Predict future learning, Place students, Evaluate teaching

Techniques to test the production of Sound Segments -

Sound Segments - Individual speech sounds mainly Vowels + Consonants

1. Imitation - Teacher gives a model. Student listens and repeats. Teacher check whether the sound is produced correctly.

2. Word production - Ask students to pronounce words containing a particular sound.

Example - /p/ → Pen, Paper, Apple

3. Minimal-pair Test - Students pronounce pairs of words containing contrasting sounds.

Example - Ship - Sheep, fan - Van, rice - size

4. Reading aloud - Give students a list of words and sentences. Students read aloud. The teacher evaluates pronunciation.

5. Picture-based production - Show a picture and ask the learner to name it. Example - Picture of a fish. Student says the word. The teacher evaluates the relevant sound.

Techniques to test Intonation - Intonation is rise and fall of pitch in speech.

1. Reading Sentences Aloud
2. Question and answers
3. Situational Tasks
4. Dialogue Reading

Techniques to test the production of Lexical units -

Lexical units - Words or vocabulary items

1. Picture Naming
2. Word Completion
3. Sentence Completion
4. Word Association
5. Synonyms
6. Antonyms
7. Use the word in a sentence.

Testing Auditory Comprehension -

Auditory Comprehension - Understanding language we hear

1. Listening and answering questions
2. Statement True/False after listening
3. Multiple Choice

4. Following Instructions
5. Dictation
6. Note-Taking

How to Test Speaking Ability -

Speaking Ability - Learner's ability to communicate orally in English.

4. Speaking Test assess Pronunciation + Grammar + Vocabulary + Fluency + Comprehensibility + Communication

1. Interview
2. Conversation
3. Picture Description
4. Role-play
5. Story Retelling
6. Topic presentation

Achievement Testing - Measures the knowledge and skills that learners have gained from a course or period of instruction.

Diagnostic Testing - Find out specific areas in which learner has difficulty.

4. Identifies learner's strengths and

Weaknesses.

Aptitude Testing - Attempts to measure a learner's potential or capacity for learning something.

4. Language aptitude testing estimates how readily a person may learn a new language under appropriate conditions.